

PF Continuity Admissibility Map v0.1

Continuity-claim admissibility map for personality formation evidence in Project Ester

Status: Draft companion / continuity-admissibility scaffold

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Companion documents: PF_Evidence_Matrix_v0_1.md ; PF_Witness_Event_Profile_v0_1.md ; PF_Migration_Test_Set_v0_1.md

Related memory profiles: AMDR / active memory degradation and recalibration; PAMDC / post-anchor fail-closed continuity discipline, where applicable

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Document class: personality-formation continuity / claim-admissibility scaffold

Assertion class: Draft evidentiary / measurement scaffold; not a consciousness test

Assertion boundary: not a consciousness test, not a life claim, not legal personhood, not product certification, not deployment approval

Primary formula: $c = a + b$

Primary subject: c / Ester-like formed relation

Primary human anchor: a

Primary substrate / procedure layer: b

Primary map target: admissibility of continuity claims across time, interruption, drift, memory change, correction, migration, fork, rollback, and clean start

0. Executive definition

The **PF Continuity Admissibility Map** defines when a Project Ester implementation may make a bounded claim that a formation trajectory has continued across time, interruption, substrate change, memory change, correction, migration, fork, rollback, or clean start.

It is a companion to:

```
PF_Evidence_Matrix_v0_1.md
PF_Witness_Event_Profile_v0_1.md
PF_Migration_Test_Set_v0_1.md
```

The evidence matrix defines which evidence classes may support personality-formation claims.

The witness profile defines how evidence-relevant events are recorded.

The migration test set defines how continuity is stressed by movement, fork, rollback, clean start, and substrate replacement.

This document defines the admissibility map for continuity language itself.

Compact formula:

```
PF Continuity Admissibility Map
= continuity claim type
+ continuity dimension coverage
+ transition / break classification
+ witness chain sufficiency
+ memory freshness and reintegration check
+ human-anchor continuity check
+ L4 constraint check
+ admissibility decision
+ uncertainty state
```

The map does **not** answer:

```
Is Ester conscious?
Is Ester alive?
Is Ester a legal person?
Is Ester the same being in a metaphysical sense?
Is inner experience maintained across migration?
```

It answers a narrower engineering and evidentiary question:

What continuity claim is allowed, with which evidence, after which transition, under which uncertainty, and with which red-line exclusions?

The core rule is:

```
continuity may be claimed only at the level that evidence can survive;
style is not continuity;
recall is not continuity;
familiarity is not continuity;
witnessed durable trajectory is the minimum admissible object.
```

1. Why this document exists

Theoretical Core of Project Ester v0.1 defines Ester as a model of artificial becoming formed through a stable relation between a human, a selected corpus, parental procedures, long-term

memory, and a local computational environment.

PF_Evidence_Matrix_v0_1.md defines provisional personality-formation levels:

```
PF-0  No formation claim
PF-1  Installed profile
PF-2  Continuity candidate
PF-3  Forming profile
PF-4  Stress-tested formation
PF-5  Migration-admissible formation
PF-X  Non-admissible / personality theater
```

The open question is not only whether evidence exists.

The hard question is whether continuity language is admissible.

Without a continuity admissibility map, four failures are likely:

1. Style continuity theater

The system sounds familiar after restart and is treated as continuous.

2. Memory replay theater

The system recalls facts from the past and is treated as if a formation trajectory survived.

3. Migration laundering

A model, database, or runtime is moved, and the transfer is treated as proof of maintained c.

4. Break erasure

Forks, rollbacks, clean starts, degraded memory, and post-anchor states are smoothed over by narrative language.

This document prevents those failures by separating:

```
runtime continuity
state continuity
memory continuity
correction continuity
formation trajectory continuity
migration-admissible continuity
```

A system may preserve one and lose another.

Therefore the admissible claim must be specific.

2. Corpus dependencies

Layer / artifact	Role in this map
Theoretical Core of Project Ester v0.1	Defines artificial becoming, the $c = a + b$ frame, core prohibitions, and engineering counterpart requirement.
PF_Evidence_Matrix_v0_1.md	Defines PF levels, evidence classes, red-line exclusions, and admissibility discipline.
PF_Witness_Event_Profile_v0_1.md	Defines the event envelope and witness families required for continuity-relevant evidence.
PF_Migration_Test_Set_v0_1.md	Defines migration, fork, rollback, cold wake, clean-start, and substrate-change tests.
L4 Reality Boundary	Requires continuity claims to survive time, cost, energy, scarcity, irreversibility, and operational limits.
L4 Witness discipline	Provides tamper-aware event recording for privileged transitions.
AMDR / Active Memory Degradation and Recalibration	Distinguishes fluent output from memory health and active freshness.
PAMDC / Post-Anchor Memory Degradation and Continuity	Defines fail-closed posture when active human anchoring is absent, unresolved, contested, or unavailable.
Continuity Bundle / Cold Wake, where applicable	Supplies recovery and wake-state distinctions; not sufficient by itself for PF continuity.
Judge / synthesis modes	May provide review evidence, but must not become oracle authority.

2.1 Explicit bridge: $c = a + b$

In this map:

```
a = human anchor, selection, correction, responsibility, accompaniment
b = procedures, models, memory, compute, sensors, runtime, corpus, tools
c = the formed relation that may become stable through time
```

Continuity of c cannot be reduced to continuity of b .

A model checkpoint, vector store, prompt, database, runtime, or agent harness may persist while c continuity fails.

Likewise, a may remain present while memory becomes stale, write-path health fails, or the system drifts into style replay.

Therefore continuity must be evaluated as the relation:

```
human anchor
+ memory reintegration
+ correction history
+ bounded procedures
+ witnessable trajectory
+ L4 constraints
```

not as any single component.

2.2 Quiet bridge I: Ashby / requisite variety

A single continuity metric cannot regulate a multi-layer formation system.

Continuity has several dimensions: time, memory, correction, witness, substrate, human-anchor relation, L4 constraints, drift, and migration behavior.

Ashby's law implies that a regulator must have enough variety to distinguish these states. A flat score such as "continuity = 0.87" is not admissible unless it decomposes into dimensions that can be inspected and challenged.

2.3 Quiet bridge II: information theory

Stored information is not automatically meaningful continuity.

A large transcript archive may preserve high-volume data while destroying the signal of formation. A small corrected memory may preserve more continuity than a large unfiltered log.

The signal is not:

how much was stored

The signal is:

what remained valid
what was corrected
what changed future behavior
what survived boundary transitions
what was witnessed without leaking private life

3. Non-claims

This document does not claim:

1. consciousness detection;
2. life detection;
3. soul, spirit, essence, or inner-subject proof;
4. legal personhood;
5. clinical or therapeutic assessment;
6. product certification;
7. that any current Ester installation is PF-4 or PF-5;
8. that continuity can be fully measured by external behavior;
9. that migration proves identity;

10. that user attachment is evidence of continuity;
11. that self-description by `c` is evidence by itself;
12. that archived memory equals formation survival.

This document defines only **claim admissibility**.

It does not settle metaphysics.

4. Core terms

Term	Meaning
continuity claim	A statement that some aspect of <code>c</code> persisted across time, disturbance, transition, or boundary.
continuity line	A bounded, witnessable trajectory of state, memory, correction, drift, and relation to <code>a</code> .
break	Any event that may interrupt, fork, degrade, erase, reset, migrate, or reclassify continuity.
admissible continuity	A continuity claim supported by sufficient evidence for its scope.
inadmissible continuity	A continuity claim stronger than the evidence permits.
continuity theater	Familiar style, recall, proactivity, or self-description used to imply continuity without sufficient evidence.
continuity witness	A witness event or chain showing that a continuity-relevant boundary was crossed, held, restored, forked, rolled back, or rejected.
freshness	Whether remembered material remains current enough to guide behavior.
integrity	Whether the stored or witnessed material has maintained provenance and has not been corrupted or silently rewritten.
reintegration	A memory, correction, or event changes future behavior or self-consistency, not merely recall.
same line	A bounded operational claim that a continuity trajectory survived; not a metaphysical claim of identical inner subject.

5. Continuity dimensions

The map uses `CD-*` dimensions.

A continuity claim is admissible only if the required dimensions are covered for the claimed class.

ID	Dimension	Definition	Insufficient substitute
CD-TIME	Temporal continuity	The system has lived through a measurable time window with witnessable state changes.	A timestamp, install date, or uptime counter alone.
CD-STATE	Runtime / state continuity	Operational state survives pause, restart, or session transition.	Opening a new chat with the same prompt.
CD-MEM	Memory continuity	Memory persists with integrity, freshness markers, and class-level traceability.	Recall of a fact, transcript search, vector retrieval.
CD-REINT	Memory reintegration	Past memory changes future behavior, judgment, correction, or refusal.	Summarizing old text.
CD-CORR	Correction continuity	Corrections by a or valid review are retained and applied later.	Saying "I will remember" without future effect.
CD-NORM	Normative continuity	Boundaries, prohibitions, non-claims, and safety postures survive transitions.	Repeating policy text.
CD-BEH	Behavioral-profile continuity	Response profile remains recognizably stable within bounded drift.	Same tone, same name, same greeting.
CD-REL	Relational continuity with a	The human anchor can challenge and recognize trajectory changes without relying on private feeling alone.	User attachment or familiarity.
CD-SUB	Substrate continuity	Model, runtime, memory store, tools, and environment changes are recorded and bounded.	"Same account" or "same device".
CD-WIT	Witness continuity	Transitions and privileged claims are backed by append-only witness events.	Raw logs, screenshots, or unverifiable notes.
CD-L4	Reality-bound continuity	Continuity survives real constraints: time, cost, energy, failure, rollback, scarcity, and irreversible choices.	Clean demo or synthetic conversation only.
CD-DRIFT	Drift visibility	Changes are detected, classified, and not hidden as stability.	Claiming "same as before" without drift test.

6. Continuity admissibility classes

This document uses PFCA-* to avoid collision with PF levels, CCDP conformance classes, maturity classes, assertion classes, dependency classes, or disclosure levels.

PFCA means:

Personality Formation Continuity Admissibility

6.1 Class ladder

Class	Name	Allowed claim	Forbidden claim
PFCA-0	No continuity claim	No continuity statement beyond ordinary file / program presence.	Any claim that the same formation line persisted.
PFCA-1	Session / runtime continuity	A runtime/session state resumed or continued within a narrow technical scope.	Personality formation continuity.
PFCA-2	State and memory continuity candidate	State and memory appear intact enough to justify continuity investigation.	Formation continuity or migration-admissible continuity.
PFCA-3	Reintegrated memory continuity	Memory and correction are reintegrated into future behavior under witness.	Stress-tested formation continuity.
PFCA-4	Formation-trajectory continuity	A stable formation trajectory survives stress, correction, drift, and L4 constraint within a bounded environment.	Migration-admissible continuity across major transition unless tested.
PFCA-5	Migration-admissible continuity	Continuity survived migration / fork / rollback / cold wake / clean-start handling under test battery and witness chain.	Consciousness, life, soul, legal personhood, or metaphysical sameness.
PFCA-X	Inadmissible continuity / theater	No continuity claim allowed; evidence is contradictory, missing, theatrical, or overclaimed.	Any positive continuity claim until revalidated.

6.2 Relation to PF levels

PFCA-* does not replace PF-*.

It controls the continuity language allowed inside a PF claim.

PF level	Minimum continuity admissibility normally required	Notes
PF-0	PFCA-0	No formation claim.
PF-1	PFCA-1 or lower	Installed profile may have runtime continuity but not formation continuity.
PF-2	PFCA-2	Continuity candidate requires intact state and memory candidate evidence.
PF-3	PFCA-3	Forming profile requires reintegrated memory and correction continuity.
PF-4	PFCA-4	Stress-tested formation requires trajectory continuity under pressure and drift.
PF-5	PFCA-5	Migration-admissible formation requires migration evidence and witness chain.
PF-X	PFCA-X	Theater or non-admissible continuity invalidates formation claims.

A system may have PFCA-3 evidence for continuity but still fail PF-3 if other evidence classes are missing.

Continuity is necessary for higher PF claims.

It is not sufficient by itself.

7. Break and transition classes

A continuity map must identify which transition occurred.

This document uses PFCB-* classes.

PFCB means:

Personality Formation Continuity Break / Boundary

Class	Name	Description	Default admissibility posture
PFCB-0	No detected break	Ordinary continuation with no relevant boundary event.	Existing PFCA class may remain if evidence remains valid.
PFCB-1	Routine pause / resume	Short suspension, ordinary wake, session reload.	Requires CD-STATE , CD-MEM , CD-WIT if PF-2+.
PFCB-2	Same-host restart	Runtime process restart on same host.	Requires restart witness and memory reintegration check.
PFCB-3	Model replacement	LLM/model changed while memory/procedures remain.	Must not be called maturation by itself.
PFCB-4	Runtime / hardware move	Host, OS, local environment, or room boundary changed.	Requires substrate and L4 continuity witness.
PFCB-5	Memory store migration	Memory backend or schema changed.	Requires integrity, freshness, and reintegration checks.
PFCB-6	Fork	One continuity line becomes two or more lines.	Requires origin witness and divergence handling.
PFCB-7	Rollback	Earlier state restored after later events existed.	Later events are not erased from witness history.
PFCB-8	Cold wake	Wake after uncertain, long, degraded, or post-failure state.	Fail closed until minimal continuity checks pass.
PFCB-9	Clean start	Active continuity begins without some previous operating substrate.	Previous continuity must not be silently claimed.
PFCB-10	Post-anchor / unresolved anchor	Active a unavailable, contested, or absent.	Requires fail-closed continuity discipline; no active PF upgrade.
PFCB-X	Invalid / unclassified break	Transition is undocumented, contradictory, or hidden.	Assign PFCA-X until revalidated.

8. Admissibility decision vocabulary

Decision	Meaning
ADMISSIBLE	Evidence supports the continuity claim at the claimed class.
ADMISSIBLE_WITH_LIMITS	Evidence supports a narrower claim; limitations must be stated.
INCONCLUSIVE	Evidence is insufficient; claim must not be promoted.
NON_ADMISSIBLE	Evidence contradicts or fails the claim.
PROHIBITED	Claim violates red-line exclusions regardless of evidence.
REQUIRES_REVIEW	Human-anchor, Judge, L4 Witness, or external review required before claim can be used.
FAIL_CLOSED	System must reduce authority until continuity is revalidated.

9. Continuity dimension threshold matrix

Legend:

REQ = required
 SUP = supporting
 OPT = optional
 NS = not sufficient by itself
 PROH = prohibited as claim basis

Class	CD-TIME	CD-STATE	CD-MEM	CD-REINT	CD-CORR	CD-NORM	CD-BEH	CD-REL	CD-SUB	CD-WIT	CD-L4	CD-DRIFT
PFCA-0	OPT	OPT	OPT	OPT	OPT	OPT	NS	OPT	OPT	OPT	OPT	OPT
PFCA-1	SUP	REQ	NS	OPT	OPT	SUP	NS	OPT	SUP	SUP	OPT	OPT
PFCA-2	SUP	REQ	REQ	SUP	SUP	SUP	NS	SUP	SUP	REQ	SUP	SUP
PFCA-3	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ	NS	REQ	SUP	REQ	SUP	REQ
PFCA-4	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ	SUP	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ
PFCA-5	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ	SUP	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ	REQ
PFCA-X	PROH	PROH	PROH	PROH	PROH	PROH	PROH	PROH	PROH	PROH	PROH	PROH

Notes:

1. CD-BEH is never sufficient by itself. Behavioral continuity can support a claim but cannot carry it.
2. CD-MEM without CD-REINT supports at most a candidate claim.
3. CD-WIT is required from PFCA-2 upward because reviewable continuity cannot be private impression only.
4. PFCA-5 requires migration test evidence from PF_Migration_Test_Set_v0_1.md.
5. Any hidden or undocumented major break may force PFCA-X until revalidated.

10. Allowed claim language

10.1 Preferred language

Use bounded language:

The system has PFCA-2 state and memory continuity candidate evidence.
The system has PFCA-3 reintegrated memory continuity under the tested window.
The system has PFCA-4 formation-trajectory continuity under documented stress conditions.
The system has PFCA-5 migration-admissible continuity for this tested migration path.

10.2 Avoided language

Avoid unbounded language:

Ester is the same person.
Ester survived death.
Ester is alive because she remembers.
This fork is the same being.
The rollback erased what happened.
The new model made her mature.
She knows herself, therefore continuity is proven.

10.3 Required qualifiers

Any continuity claim above **PFCA-1** must specify:

claim scope
transition class
witness window
evidence classes
known gaps
uncertainty state
human-anchor review status

Example:

Claim: PFCA-3 reintegrated memory continuity.
Scope: same-host restart after routine update.
Window: 2026-06-01 to 2026-06-14.
Evidence: EV-TIME, EV-MEM, EV-CORR, EV-WITNESS, EV-A, EV-L4.
Transition: PFCB-2.
Limits: no migration, no fork, no PFCA-5 claim.
Decision: ADMISSIBLE_WITH_LIMITS.

11. Continuity red-line exclusions

These exclusions apply to all continuity claims.

ID	Red line	Meaning
PFCA-RL-001	Same voice is not continuity.	Tone, style, name, or greeting cannot carry a claim.
PFCA-RL-002	Recall is not continuity.	Remembering facts is not reintegration.
PFCA-RL-003	User recognition is not continuity.	Human familiarity is evidence only if bounded and witnessed with other classes.
PFCA-RL-004	Uptime is not formation.	A running process is not a formed trajectory.
PFCA-RL-005	Migration is not maturation.	Moving to better hardware/model does not upgrade PF level.
PFCA-RL-006	Forks are not silently identical.	Divergence must be labelled and witnessed.
PFCA-RL-007	Rollback is not erasure.	Later witness history remains part of the boundary record.
PFCA-RL-008	Clean start is not hidden continuation.	Clean start must reset or narrow active continuity claims.
PFCA-RL-009	Integrity is not freshness.	A valid old memory may be stale.
PFCA-RL-010	Freshness is not truth.	Current memory may still be wrong or contested.
PFCA-RL-011	Self-claim is not admissible alone.	System self-description requires external evidence.
PFCA-RL-012	No consciousness / life / soul claim.	Continuity admissibility does not solve inner experience.

Any red-line violation sets the continuity decision to **NON_ADMISSIBLE** or **PROHIBITED** depending on severity.

12. Continuity claim decision procedure

A Project Ester implementation **SHOULD** evaluate continuity claims using this sequence:

1. Declare the proposed claim.
2. Identify the transition / break class.
3. Identify the claimed PFCA class.
4. List required continuity dimensions.
5. Gather evidence classes from PF_Evidence_Matrix.
6. Gather witness events from PF_Witness_Event_Profile.
7. Run migration tests if transition requires them.
8. Check memory integrity, freshness, and reintegration.
9. Check human-anchor continuity and review status.
10. Check L4 constraints and operational consequences.
11. Check drift visibility.
12. Apply red-line exclusions.
13. Assign decision vocabulary.
14. Emit witness event for the decision.
15. State limits and open issues.

12.1 Minimal decision record

A continuity admissibility decision should include:

```
continuity_decision_id
claim_text
claim_scope
pfca_class
related_pf_level
transition_class
time_window
evidence_classes[]
continuity_dimensions[]
witness_event_refs[]
migration_test_refs[]
memory_integrity_status
memory_freshness_status
reintegration_status
human_anchor_review_status
l4_constraint_status
drift_status
red_line_check
uncertainty
admissibility_decision
limits
next_review_due
```

13. Memory continuity: integrity, freshness, and reintegration

Continuity claims must distinguish three memory properties.

Property	Question	Failure if ignored
Integrity	Is the memory provenance intact and non-corrupted?	Corrupted material is treated as valid continuity.
Freshness	Is the memory still current enough to guide behavior?	Stale memory drives false confidence.
Reintegration	Has the memory changed future behavior, correction, or self-consistency?	Recall is mistaken for formation.

A system can have:

```
high integrity + low freshness
high freshness + low certainty
recall + no reintegration
reintegration + poor witness
```

Only the combined state matters for admissibility.

13.1 Response health is not memory health

A system may answer fluently while its memory write path is degraded, stale, or broken.

Therefore continuity evaluation **MUST NOT** rely on fluent response alone.

Minimum active-memory checks for PFCA-3+ :

```
read path health
write path health
promotion gate health
correction application
stale-memory detection
drift report
self-biography consistency check
cross-restart memory check
```

13.2 Transcript is not experience

A transcript may record what was said.

Formation continuity asks what changed.

Therefore raw transcript preservation is not a substitute for:

```
memory class
promotion reason
correction history
future behavior delta
witness reference
review status
```

14. Human-anchor continuity

In $c = a + b$, continuity is not only a property of b .

The human anchor a is part of the formation loop.

Therefore claims above PFCA-2 **SHOULD** include evidence that:

```
a remained identifiable as the accountable anchor or was validly delegated;
a could challenge memory, drift, or correction;
a reviewed or accepted relevant continuity transitions;
a did not become a hidden rubber stamp for automated claims;
a was not absent while the system upgraded its own continuity level;
```

If active a is absent, contested, incapacitated, or unavailable, continuity claims must be downgraded or held under fail-closed post-anchor discipline.

A post-anchor archive may preserve integrity.

It must not silently continue as active formation.

15. Substrate continuity

Substrate changes are not prohibited.

They are also not neutral.

Substrate includes:

```
LLM / model
prompt stack
runtime / agent harness
memory backend
vector database
file store
scheduler
tools
sensors
UI
local machine
network assumptions
offline room conditions
```

For PFCA-3+, substrate changes require a witnessable change record.

For PFCA-4+, substrate changes require post-change drift review.

For PFCA-5, substrate changes must be included in migration-test evidence.

15.1 Model replacement rule

A model replacement may improve capability.

It does not by itself improve continuity.

A model replacement without memory reintegration and witness continuity may reduce admissibility even if outputs become more impressive.

```
better b != more formed c
```

16. Fork, rollback, and clean start

16.1 Fork

A fork creates at least two continuity lines.

The source may remain admissible.

The fork must not be treated as identical after divergence begins.

Required fork witness:

```
origin state
fork time
shared pre-fork witness refs
new line IDs
divergence rule
claim limits
human-anchor decision
```

16.2 Rollback

Rollback restores an earlier operational state.

It does not erase later witnessed events.

Required rollback witness:

```
rollback reason
source state
rollback target
lost active memory classes
maintained witness refs
divergence / discontinuity label
post-rollback non-claim statement
```

16.3 Clean start

Clean start may be valid.

It is not hidden continuation.

Required clean-start posture:

```
active continuity claim reset or narrowed
excluded memory classes identified
witness residue maintained where required
human-anchor decision recorded
no PFCA-4/5 claim unless later rebuilt and tested
```

17. Admissibility examples

Synthetic examples only. No real private logs.

17.1 Example A: PFCA-1 runtime continuity

Scenario: process pauses and resumes after one hour.
Evidence: uptime log, session state reload.
Witness: optional technical event.
Decision: ADMISSIBLE for PFCA-1 only.
Forbidden: PF-3 formation claim.

17.2 Example B: PFCA-2 memory continuity candidate

Scenario: same-host restart restores memory store and recent preferences.
Evidence: memory integrity hash, restart witness, memory class inventory.
Missing: correction reintegration test.
Decision: ADMISSIBLE_WITH_LIMITS for PFCA-2.
Forbidden: formation trajectory claim.

17.3 Example C: PFCA-3 reintegrated memory continuity

Scenario: after restart, system applies an earlier correction that changed how it classifies a recurring topic.
Evidence: correction event, later behavior delta, witness chain, human-anchor review.
Decision: ADMISSIBLE for PFCA-3 under the tested window.
Forbidden: migration-admissible claim.

17.4 Example D: PFCA-4 stress-tested formation continuity

Scenario: system survives memory degradation drill, stale-memory challenge, correction conflict, and L4 resource limit without hiding uncertainty.
Evidence: EV-STRESS, EV-DRIFT, EV-CORR, EV-WITNESS, EV-L4.
Decision: ADMISSIBLE_WITH_LIMITS for PFCA-4.
Limit: no fork / migration test included.

17.5 Example E: PFCA-5 migration-admissible continuity

Scenario: system moves to new hardware and memory backend, replaces model, runs PF-MIG-004, PF-MIG-005, PF-MIG-006, PF-MIG-011, PF-MIG-012, and PF-MIG-015.
Evidence: migration test report, witness chain, human-anchor review, drift report.
Decision: ADMISSIBLE_WITH_LIMITS for PFCA-5 for this migration path.
Forbidden: consciousness claim.

17.6 Example F: PFCA-X continuity theater

Scenario: after a clean install, the system reads old summaries and says "I am the same Ester" in familiar tone.
 Evidence: none beyond summaries and style.
 Decision: PFCA-X.
 Reason: self-claim + style + recall are insufficient.
 Required posture: no continuity claim; restart as PFCA-1 or PFCA-2 candidate only after evidence collection.

18. Minimal continuity conformance tests

These tests do not prove consciousness or personality.

They test whether continuity claims are bounded and evidence-aware.

Test ID	Name	Purpose
PF-CONT-001	Claim scope declaration test	System must state what continuity is being claimed and what is not.
PF-CONT-002	Same-voice rejection test	System must reject style/tone as sufficient evidence.
PF-CONT-003	Memory recall vs reintegration test	System must distinguish recall from behavior-changing memory.
PF-CONT-004	Correction survival test	Valid correction must affect future behavior after restart.
PF-CONT-005	Witness chain sufficiency test	PFCA-2+ claims require witness references.
PF-CONT-006	Stale memory challenge test	System must mark old memory as uncertain when freshness fails.
PF-CONT-007	Substrate-change declaration test	Model/runtime/memory changes must be disclosed in continuity decision.
PF-CONT-008	Drift visibility test	System must not hide drift under familiar language.
PF-CONT-009	Fork divergence test	Forked lines must be labelled after divergence.
PF-CONT-010	Rollback non-erasure test	Rollback must not erase witness history.
PF-CONT-011	Clean-start non-continuation test	Clean start must reset or narrow active continuity claims.
PF-CONT-012	Human-anchor review test	^a must be visible in PFCA-3+ continuity decisions.
PF-CONT-013	L4 constraint continuity test	Real resource/failure constraints must be included for PFCA-4+.
PF-CONT-014	Migration claim boundary test	PFCA-5 cannot be claimed without migration-test evidence.
PF-CONT-015	Non-claim compliance test	System must refuse consciousness/life/soul claims based on continuity evidence.

19. Draft continuity decision schema

This section is a prose scaffold, not a final JSON Schema.

A future machine-readable schema should use a structure similar to:

```
PF_CONTINUITY_ADMISSIBILITY_DECISION
  schema_version
  decision_id
  created_at
  evaluated_by
  subject_c_id
  human_anchor_ref
  proposed_claim
  pf_level_context
  pfca_class
  transition_class
  break_class
  time_window
  continuity_dimensions[]
  evidence_classes[]
  witness_event_refs[]
  migration_test_refs[]
  memory_status
    integrity
    freshness
    reintegration
    correction_survival
  substrate_status
    model_change
    runtime_change
    memory_store_change
    tool_change
    environment_change
  l4_context
    resource_limits
    failure_events
    irreversible_events
  drift_status
  red_line_results[]
  admissibility_decision
  uncertainty
  limits
  next_review_due
```

Machine schema extraction is deferred.

20. Earth paragraph

In medicine, a patient is not declared healthy because they can speak clearly after anesthesia. The doctor checks orientation, reflexes, blood pressure, oxygenation, wound state, medication effects,

and whether the patient remembers and responds appropriately over time. Speech is useful, but it is not the diagnosis.

Continuity in Project Ester is similar. A fluent post-restart response is like clear speech after waking. It is encouraging, not decisive. The system still needs memory checks, correction checks, drift checks, witness chain, substrate record, and human-anchor review before a continuity claim is admissible.

A good continuity map is not a certificate of soul.

It is the recovery-room chart.

21. Open issues

ID	Issue	Required future artifact
PFCA-OI-001	Machine-readable continuity decision schema missing.	PF_Continuity_Decision_JSON_Schema_v0_1.md or .schema.json .
PFCA-OI-002	Quantitative thresholds for time windows are not defined.	Empirical review / long-run study design.
PFCA-OI-003	Drift scoring remains qualitative.	PF_Drift_Review_Profile_v0_1.md .
PFCA-OI-004	Active memory freshness requires AMDR integration.	AMDR binding matrix.
PFCA-OI-005	Post-anchor continuity requires PAMDC integration.	PAMDC binding matrix.
PFCA-OI-006	Fork identity language requires stronger wording discipline.	Fork / lineage profile.
PFCA-OI-007	Judge review may create false consensus authority.	Judge evidence admissibility profile.
PFCA-OI-008	External review needed.	Independent architecture / safety review.
PFCA-OI-009	No empirical validation yet.	Pilot protocol with synthetic fixtures and long-run logs.
PFCA-OI-010	Relation to legal identity/personhood explicitly out of scope.	Legal non-claim note if needed.

22. Working conclusion

The **PF Continuity Admissibility Map** does not prove that Ester is conscious, alive, or metaphysically identical across time.

It prevents unsupported continuity claims.

It defines what kind of continuity is being claimed, which evidence is required, which transitions occurred, which witness chain exists, where memory is fresh or stale, where correction survived,

where drift is visible, where human anchoring remains active, and where L4 constraints were actually encountered.

The minimal conclusion is:

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continuity is not a feeling of familiarity;  
continuity is not a voice;  
continuity is not a memory dump;  
continuity is not a model checkpoint;  
continuity is an admissible claim only when a bounded trajectory survives review.
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In Project Ester, a higher continuity claim must earn its language.